WP-4B-04: Morphine and other controlled drugs

Example General Hospital, Ward 4B. Version 3 (fictional). Owner: Ward 4B nurse in charge (fictional role).

FICTIONAL TRAINING DOCUMENT. Not clinical guidance. Example General Hospital is fictional.

Scope

Adult inpatients on Ward 4B receiving morphine by mouth or intravenously, and any other controlled drug.

Controlled drug checks

- Two registered nurses check every controlled drug dose against the prescription and the controlled drug register.
- Both nurses sign the register. The second nurse witnesses the administration, not only the preparation.
- Any part dose that is not given is destroyed in front of the second nurse and recorded.

Before every dose

Record the respiratory rate, sedation score and pain score in MedTrack. Do not give the dose if the patient is difficult to rouse.

Monitoring after a dose

Intravenous morphine: record respiratory rate and sedation score every 15 minutes for 1 hour.

Oral morphine: record respiratory rate and sedation score 1 hour after the dose.

When to escalate

Respiratory rate below 8 breaths per minute, or the patient is difficult to rouse: stop all opioids, call for help immediately, and give naloxone as prescribed. Naloxone is kept on the Ward 4B emergency trolley.

Ward 4B local rule

The nurse in charge reviews the controlled drug register at every shift handover and records the stock check.